

New Zealand



South Pacific islands first settled 1,000 years ago by the Maori, who call the country Aotearoa.

1000–1200 The Maori reach New Zealand from eastern Polynesia.

1642 The Dutch explorer Abel Tasman sights the west coast of the South Island.

1769 Captain James Cook makes the first of three visits to New Zealand.

1840 British sovereignty is proclaimed with the signing of the Treaty of Waitangi by a British representative and leaders of some Maori tribes. Settlers from the UK arrive at Port Nicholson (now Wellington).

1852 The British parliament passes a Constitution Act, which creates a House of Representatives and Legislative Council.

1860 The Taranaki war begins when British troops try to remove Maori people from land allegedly bought by the Crown.

1863 War between the Maori and British troops breaks out over land in Waikato. The land is eventually confiscated.

1867 Four Maori seats are established in the House of Representatives.

1890 A Liberal government is elected, with John Ballance as premier.

1893 Women are given the vote.

1894 The Liberal government, now under the leadership of Richard John Seddon, passes legislation providing for industrial arbitration, better factory conditions, and old-age pensions.

1907 New Zealand becomes an independent dominion, self-governing from 1926 although remaining subordinate to the UK parliament.

1947 Gains full independence when it adopts the 1931 Statute of Westminster.

1962 Western Samoa (now Samoa) gains independence from New Zealand.

1975 Conservative National Party (NP) wins elections. Economic austerity program is introduced.

1984 Labour Party (LP) elected with David Lange prime minister. Auckland harbor headland restored to Maoris.

1985 New Zealand bans nuclear vessels from ports and waters. French agents sink Greenpeace ship *Rainbow Warrior* in Auckland harbor.

1986 US suspends military obligations under military ANZUS Treaty.

1987 LP wins elections and implements widespread privatization. Nuclear ban is enshrined in legislation.



The Maori

The first settlers in New Zealand were the Maori from Polynesia, who make up about one-eighth of New Zealand's 3.9-million residents. In recent years they have waged successful claims for the return of their traditional lands.

1989 Cabinet split: Lange resigns and is succeeded by Geoffrey Palmer.

1990 Palmer resigns. LP defeated by NP in elections. James Bolger prime minister.

1992 Maori win South Island fishing rights.

1993 Docking of first French naval ship for eight years. NP returned with single-seat majority in election.

NEW ZEALAND

OVERSEAS TERRITORIES

New Zealand is an unwilling colonial power and has no wish to keep overseas territories. Their economic weakness forces New Zealand to take responsibility for their foreign policy and defense.

TOKELAU

Three small atolls to the north of Samoa. 1926 Sovereignty transferred from UK.

ROSS DEPENDENCY

New Zealand's Antarctic territory. 1923 Created by imperial order. 1959 Territorial claims frozen.

SELF-GOVERNING OVERSEAS TERRITORIES

COOK ISLANDS

A group of atolls and volcanic islands in the South Pacific.

1888 British protectorate is set up. 1901 Annexed as part of New Zealand. 1965 Islands become a self-governing territory in association with New Zealand.

NIUE

The world's largest coral island. 1900 Annexed by the UK and transferred to New Zealand in 1901. 1974 Is granted self-governing status.

1993 Majority vote in referendum to adopt proportional representation.

1994 Senior-level US contacts are restored; US agrees not to send nuclear-armed ships to New Zealand ports. Maori reject government 10-year land claims settlement of NZ\$1 billion.

1995 Waitangi Day celebrations are abandoned after Maori protests. Crown apologizes to the Maori and signs Waikato Raupatu Claims Settlement Act.

1996 NP forms coalition to preserve overall legislative majority after first general election under new PR system.

1997 NP forms coalition with New Zealand First (NZF) party. Jenny Shipley becomes first woman prime minister.

1998 Shipley sacks NZF leader Winston Peters as deputy prime minister, and forms a minority government when coalition splits. Waitangi Tribunal orders the government to return to the Maori NZ\$6.1 million-worth of confiscated land.

1999 LP led by Helen Clark wins general election. She is reelected in 2002 and again in 2005. NZ troops join UN peacekeeping force in East Timor.

2006 Maori Queen, Te Arikinui Dame Te Atairangikaahu, dies at age 75.

2008 John Key's National Party wins a general election, ending nine years of Labour rule. Fiji and New Zealand expel each other's top diplomats in a row over Fiji's postponement of elections. Full diplomatic ties are restored only in 2010.

2011 City of Christchurch on South Island hit by major earthquake.

«216–17 Polynesian Expansion
«282–83 Exploring the Pacific
«350–51 Colonial Resistance

Papua New Guinea



The world's most linguistically diverse country with more than 750 languages spoken.

1526 Portuguese explorer Jorge de Meneses lands on the northwest coast.

1545 Spanish first claim the whole island of New Guinea.

1828 The Dutch claim the western part of the island as part of the Dutch East Indies; it now forms part of Indonesia.

1884 The UK lays claim to the southeast coast of New Guinea island, and to the islands to the east, which it annexes in 1888. Germany claims the northeast coast and nearby islands.

1902 Australia takes over British sector, which is renamed Papua in 1906.

1914 German sector occupied by Australia.

1920 Former German New Guinea is mandated by the League of Nations to Australia; the mandate is renewed after World War II by the UN.

1942–45 Japanese occupation.

1964 National Parliament created.

1971 Renamed Papua New Guinea.

1975 Independence under Michael Somare, leader since 1972.

1988 Bougainville Revolutionary Army (BRA) begins guerrilla campaign to achieve independence for their island.

1994 Peace treaty between the government and BRA rebels sets up a provisional Bougainville government; fighting resumes in 1995.

1997 El Niño effect causes severe drought and storms.

1997 Sir Julius Chan resigns as prime minister over the use of Western-led mercenaries to put down the rebellion in Bougainville. Permanent ceasefire achieved in Bougainville in 1998.

2000 Loloata Understanding promises autonomy for Bougainville.

2001 Peace agreement with Bougainville ratified after three-year ceasefire.

2005 New autonomous Bougainville government is sworn into office after largely peaceful elections.

2007 Parliament legalizes casinos and online gambling in a bid to boost economy.

2009 Papua New Guinea suffers its first recorded outbreak of cholera.

«282–83 Exploring the Pacific